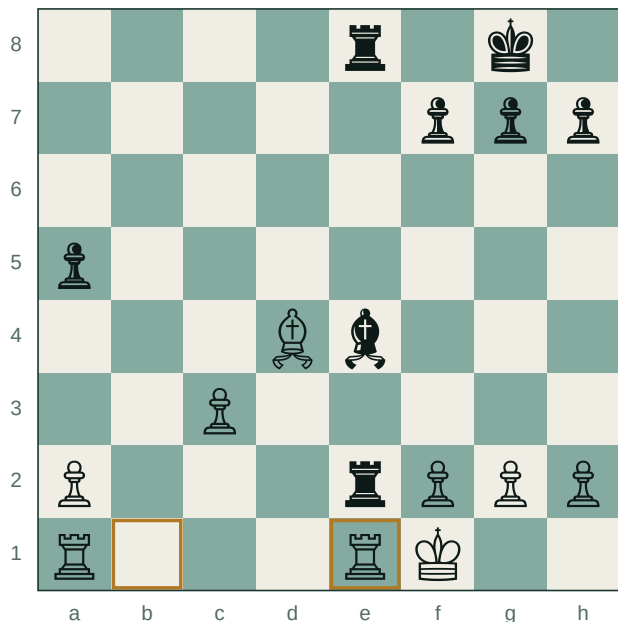


Deflection tactics: Black, move 26

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 26.Re1. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

26...Bxg2+ 27. Kxg2 Rxe1 28. Rxe1 Rxe1

26...Bxg2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the pawn on g2. Recorded reply: **27.Kxg2**.

27...Rxe1 The rook captures the rook on e1. Recorded reply: **28.Rxe1**.

28...Rxe1 The rook captures the rook on e1.

At the end, nominal material is White 7 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on f1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.